

Marcelo Denis Woo

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Address: 7 Collin Street, Nottingham, United Kingdom

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics

University of Nottingham

Oct. 2021 – Present

Nottingham, U.K.

MRes in Economics (Top student)

University of Nottingham

Oct. 2020 – Sep. 2021

Nottingham, U.K.

Diploma in Machine Learning and Deep Learning

Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires (ITBA)

2019

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Master in Economics (Best dissertation)

Universidad de San Andrés

2019

Buenos Aires, Argentina

B.A. in Economics

Universidad de San Andrés

2011

Buenos Aires, Argentina

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Behavioral Economics, Applied Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Contagious Ignorance: Theory and Experiment on the Interdependence of Information Avoidance [PDF](#)

with Silvia Sonderegger and Fabio Tufano

We study whether the deliberate avoidance of useful and freely available information can be interdependent across people. Agents derive direct utility from their beliefs about their state-dependent future consumption, potentially creating an incentive to avoid belief-inducing information. Building on Bénabou (2013), our model predicts that when remaining ignorant imposes negative externalities on others' future payoffs, individuals' decisions to acquire or avoid information may exhibit strategic complementarities (making ignorance contagious), strategic substitutabilities (making it self-limiting), or be unconditional. We test these predictions in a novel experiment where participants choose whether to learn a payoff-relevant state and where remaining ignorant worsens future payoffs of all group members. Consistent with contagious ignorance, exogenously increasing expectations about the prevalence of information avoidance raises participants' own propensity to avoid information. Evidence suggests this contagion of ignorance is mediated by a deterioration in anticipatory utility upon learning bad news, which become more severe as ignorance becomes more common. Individuals differ substantially in their best-responses to others' informational choices: around 40% of subjects condition their informational choices on those of others, split evenly between strategic complements and strategic substitutes. The mixture of such types affects equilibrium share of information avoiders monotonically and nonlinearly. Our findings suggest that optimal incentive schemes aiming to promote the aggregate take-up of information should account for interdependences in information decisions.

PUBLICATIONS

Discrimination with Inaccurate Beliefs and Confirmation Bias [PDF](#)

with Christian Ruzzier. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, June 2023.

We examine patterns of discrimination when employers hold incorrect beliefs about the relationship between group membership and productivity, and suffer from confirmation bias when updating their beliefs. As a result, employers do not correct them fully, leading to persistent wage discrimination. Negative stereotypes generate discrimination

against minority workers upon entry to the labor market, but are not enough to have discrimination in the long run, and reversals in discrimination are possible. We also discuss whether interventions aimed at reducing discrimination would succeed if confirmation bias is an important source of discrimination, and consider segregation in an extension with heterogeneous employers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mercado Libre

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Largest e-commerce and fintech company in Latin America ([More Info](#))

Data Scientist, Marketing Science

Mar. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- **Big Data Processing:** Processed 900M+ monthly transactions (e-commerce & fintech) in SQL, enabling marketing analytics across 18 countries.

Samsung Electronics

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Product Manager, Product & Marketing, Digital Appliances Division

Mar. 2016 – Feb. 2020

- **Best Employee Award:** Overcame several external delays in product development to achieve on-time launch of air conditioners (with demand concentrated in 2 months) by shortening critical path of logistics by 1 month, securing 15% of division's annual revenue target.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Partnered with cross-functional teams (sales, marketing, supply chain, customer service) across three countries to drive product and marketing strategy, managing 50% of the division's revenue.

Supply Chain Management Coordinator, Digital Appliances Division

Mar. 2013 – Mar. 2016

- **Operational Excellence Award:** Achieved >90% Forecast Accuracy (vs. 70% target) and > 90% Sales Target Accuracy, key results contributing to the subsidiary's Global Operational Excellence Award for 16 consecutive months.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Nottingham

Nottingham, UK

Postgraduate Teaching Assistant (PGTA)

Sep. 2021 – Present

Introduction to Microeconomics, Quantitative Methods, Applied Econometrics I & II, Politics of Economics, Experimental & Behavioural Economics, Economics Dissertation.

Universidad de San Andrés

Buenos Aires, Argentina

Top Economics department in Argentina ([Link](#))

Invited Professor, Department of Economics

June 2022 – Present

Behavioral Economics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

IZA / University of Bonn, Professor [Florian Zimmermann](#)

Bonn, Germany

Research Visiting

May 2025 – Jun. 2025

- Research visiting on Job Market Paper, hosted by professor [Florian Zimmermann](#).

University of Nottingham, Professor [John Gathergood](#)

Nottingham, UK

Research Assistant

Jul. 2023 – Nov. 2023

- Project on gender inequalities in academia in the U.K. Used parallelized webscraping with Python's `beautifulsoup` library to build database of about 88,000 U.K. research outputs and their authors. Used a Machine Learning algorithm to classify authors' gender based on first and middle names.

University of Nottingham, Professor [Valeria Rueda](#)

Nottingham, UK

Research Assistant

Nov. 2021 – Sep. 2022

- Project on [the effect of political activism on women's electoral participation](#). Webscraped and built database of the universe of U.K. parliament speeches on gender and the woman's suffrage movement from 1910-1914 (11,700 speeches) in Python. Implemented text-analysis.

CONFERENCES / PRESENTATIONS

2025: Field Days (LISER), IZA Applied Lunch seminar (IZA), CCC Meeting (University of Amsterdam), Midlands Empirical Economics Workshop (University of Leicester), Applied Micro Group (University of Nottingham), CeDEx Brown Bag (University of Nottingham)

2024: Copenhagen Network of Experimental Economics (CNEE) Conference, CeDEx Brown Bag (University of Nottingham)

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

Academic Awards

- **Best PhD student presentation**, Year 2. PhD Annual Conference, University of Nottingham, 2023.
- **Best Performance in MRes** in Economics (top score), University of Nottingham, 2021.
- **RIDGE-Nottingham Scholarship**: full funding for 5 years (awarded to only 1 student from Latin America).
- **Best Dissertation in Master in Economics** (selected from 40+ eligible theses), Universidad de San Andrés, 2019.
- **Teaching Excellence Award**, University of Nottingham, 2021/22 and 2022/23.

Industry Awards

- **Best employee award** for “outstanding behavior and valuable contributions to business”, Samsung Electronics, 2017 (among 200+ eligible employees).
- **Global Operational Excellence award** (key contributor for award at subsidiary level), Samsung Electronics, 2016.

Certifications / Courses

- “Foundations of Machine Learning”, University of Oxford (taught by Maximilian Kasy), Sep. 2024.
- “Randomized Controlled Trials”, Barcelona School of Economics (Owen Ozier & Pamela Jakiela), Jul. 2023.
- “Behavioral Field Experiments” PhD course, ESA, Hanken School of Economics, Aug. 2024.
- “Gender Economics”, Paris School of Economics, Jun. 2023.
- “Statistics”, “Fundamentals of Programming”, and “Fundamentals of Linear Algebra”, Master in Information and Data Science (MIDS), U.C. Berkeley, 2020.¹
- “Statistical Learning in R” (with distinction), Stanford University, Mar. 2020.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometrics, Machine Learning & Data Science: Python, Stata, R, SQL

Experiments & Surveys: Qualtrics, Lioness.

Version Control: Git

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) | English (proficient) | Korean (intermediate) | French (basic).

¹Dropped out from further modules due to funding constraints.

SERVICE

- Volunteered to improve inclusion and work environment at Samsung Electronics by providing Korean culture induction to Argentine new hires, enhancing cross-cultural understanding and preventing frictions at work for 20+ new employees annually.
- PhD Representative, [Centre for Decision Research and Experimental Economics \(CeDEx\)](#), 2024-2025.
- Co-organiser of CeDEx Brown Bag seminars, 2022-2024.

REFERENCES

Professor [Silvia Sonderegger](#)

University of Nottingham
School of Economics
Nottingham NG7 2RD
silvia.sonderegger@nottingham.ac.uk

Professor [Fabio Tufano](#)

University of Leicester
School of Business, Department of Economics, Finance,
and Accounting
266 London Road, Leicester, LE2 1RQ, UK
fabio.tufano@leicester.ac.uk

Professor [Simon Gächter](#)

University of Nottingham
School of Economics
Nottingham NG7 2RD
simon.gaechter@nottingham.ac.uk

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